

Archaeology Sorting Challenge

Cut out, draw, sort, colour and glue into your HASS book

Your mission

You are an archaeology team. Your job is to examine mixed-up evidence cards from ancient civilisations. First, draw what each piece of evidence might look like. Then sort the cards into the category where you think they belong. There may be more than one possible answer, so you must be ready to explain your reason.

You need:

☐ scissors

☐ glue

☐ coloured pencils/textas

☐ HASS book

Steps

- 1 Draw:** Sketch what each piece of evidence might look like in the blank box.
- 2 Cut:** Cut out the category headings and the evidence cards. Keep them mixed up.
- 3 Sort:** Place each evidence card under the category where you think it belongs.
- 4 Colour:** Colour-code the cards or headings after you have made your decision.
- 5 Glue:** Glue your sorted cards into your HASS book and complete the explanation box.

Sorting categories

Objects people made tools, pottery, weapons, jewellery, money

Human remains bones, teeth, mummified bodies

Places and structures roads, tombs, temples, walls, drainage

Environmental evidence seeds, charcoal, shells, animal bones

Written or symbolic evidence symbols, writing, carvings, painted images

Glue-in explanation box

One evidence card I sorted was _____.

I placed it in the category _____ because _____.

This evidence might tell archaeologists _____.

One thing we still cannot know for sure is _____.

Category Heading Cut-Outs

Cut these out first. Glue them as headings in your HASS book.

Objects people made

tools, pottery, weapons, jewellery, money

Human remains

bones, teeth, mummified bodies

Places and structures

roads, tombs, temples, walls, drainage

Environmental evidence

seeds, charcoal, shells, animal bones

Written or symbolic evidence

symbols, writing, carvings, painted images

Your own category

Use this if your group creates a better heading.

After gluing your categories, write one reason for your sorting system:

We sorted the evidence this way because _____

Mixed-Up Evidence Cards

Draw first. Then cut, sort, colour and glue.

Clay tablet

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A flat clay object with marks pressed into it.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Jewellery or beads

Draw the evidence here

Clue: Small decorated items worn on the body.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Animal bones

Draw the evidence here

Clue: Bones left near an ancient living area.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

City wall

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A large defensive structure around a settlement.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Teeth

Draw the evidence here

Clue: Human teeth found with other remains.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Papyrus scroll

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A rolled writing material used in ancient Egypt.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Bronze sword

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A metal weapon found near a burial or battle site.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Drainage channel

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A built water system found in an ancient city.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Stone tool

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A sharpened stone used for cutting or scraping.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Cave painting

Draw the evidence here

Clue: Images painted on a rock wall or cave surface.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Shell midden

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A pile of shells and food scraps left behind.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Pyramid or tomb

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A burial structure connected to beliefs about death.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Mixed-Up Evidence Cards

Draw first. Then cut, sort, colour and glue.

Coin

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A small metal object used for money or trade.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Ochre

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A red or yellow natural pigment used for painting or ceremony.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Hearth or fireplace

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A place where people made fire for cooking or warmth.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Skull

Draw the evidence here

Clue: Part of a human skeleton found by archaeologists.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Pottery shard

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A broken piece of a clay pot, bowl or storage jar.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Temple ruin

Draw the evidence here

Clue: The remains of a building used for worship or ceremony.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Charcoal

Draw the evidence here

Clue: Burnt wood pieces found in an ancient layer.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Hieroglyph carving

Draw the evidence here

Clue: Symbols carved into stone or painted on a wall.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Farming sickle

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A curved tool used for cutting crops.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Leg bone with injury

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A human bone showing damage or healing.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Seeds or grain

Draw the evidence here

Clue: Tiny plant remains preserved at a site.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Ancient road

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A built path connecting towns, cities or trade routes.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Mixed-Up Evidence Cards

Draw first. Then cut, sort, colour and glue.

Mummified body

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A preserved human body wrapped or treated after death.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Water jar

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A clay container used for carrying or storing liquid.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Statue fragment

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A broken part of a statue or figure.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Oracle bone

Draw the evidence here

Clue: Animal bone or shell with writing or carved marks.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Sealed storage jar

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A closed container that may have held food, oil or grain.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Quipu / knotted cord

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A cord with knots used to record information.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Terracotta soldier piece

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A clay fragment from a model soldier or figure.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Kiln or oven remains

Draw the evidence here

Clue: A fired structure used for baking pottery, bricks or food.

This might tell archaeologists: _____

Teacher Guide - Suggested Answers

Do not print this page for students unless you want to reveal categories.

Purpose

Students practise archaeological classification before they interpret evidence. The aim is not one perfect answer. A good answer is one students can justify using evidence, context and historical vocabulary.

Objects people made

Pottery shard, Stone tool, Bronze sword, Farming sickle, Jewellery or beads, Coin, Water jar, Sealed storage jar, Statue fragment, Terracotta soldier piece, Kiln or oven remains

Human remains

Skull, Teeth, Leg bone with injury, Mummified body

Places and structures

Temple ruin, City wall, Drainage channel, Pyramid or tomb, Hearth or fireplace, Ancient road

Environmental evidence

Shell midden, Animal bones, Seeds or grain, Charcoal, Ochre

Teacher prompts

- Which evidence card was hardest to classify? Why?
- Could any card belong in more than one category?
- What evidence would tell us about food, technology, beliefs, trade or government?
- What can archaeologists infer? What can they not know for sure?